

No Time



Member-only story

Share through stories.

CLAUDE EXPLAINED | CLAUDE AI FOR BEGINNERS | ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

[Follow publication](#)

Basic Claude Knowledge Everyone Should Have in 2026

Everything You Need to Know



Pranit naik

Follow

5 min read · 4 days ago



232



4



2



Claude Beginners guide (Image Created by Author)

Read here for [FREE](#)

Claude crossed 245 million monthly users earlier this year, and Anthropic just filed confidential paperwork for an IPO that could value the company close to a trillion dollars. If the last time you opened Claude was for a quick

question or a homework help session, you're going to be surprised by how much it can actually do now.

Q 1

It's no longer just a chat window. It's a model family, a coding agent, a desktop assistant, a plugin system, and increasingly, something plugged straight into your email, your spreadsheets, and your calendar.

Here's a plain rundown of what Claude actually is in 2026, what each piece does, and why so many businesses are quietly switching to it.

The models, in plain terms

Claude isn't one model, it's a lineup. Right now there are three tiers most people will actually touch:

- **Opus** is the most capable and most expensive, meant for harder reasoning, research, and big coding work.
- **Sonnet** is the balanced one. It's usually what you're talking to by default in the app, fast enough for daily use and smart enough for most real work.
- **Haiku** is the fastest and cheapest, built for simple, high volume tasks where speed matters more than depth.

There's also a tier above Opus called Mythos, which is meant to be Anthropic's most advanced model class. As of now, public access to it is paused because of an export control matter, so it's not something most people will be using day to day. Worth knowing it exists, not worth waiting around for.

Projects and Artifacts

Projects let you group related chats together, upload reference files, and set custom instructions so Claude stays consistent across a body of ongoing work, a client account, a course you're building, a codebase you're maintaining.

Artifacts are the separate panel where code, documents, or small working apps show up so you can view and revise them without scrolling back through the whole conversation.

Skills, Connectors, and Plugins

These 3 get mixed up constantly, so here's the plain version.

- **Skills** are instructions Claude reads before doing a task, basically a how to manual for one specific job, like writing in your brand's voice or formatting a report a certain way every time.
- **Connectors** give Claude access to your actual apps and data, Gmail, Google Drive, Calendar, Slack, Notion, and dozens of others, through plumbing called MCP that you don't really need to understand, just know it's what lets Claude talk to other software.
- **Plugins** bundle Skills, Connectors, and shortcut commands into one installable package built around a role, say a marketing plugin or a small business finance plugin.

All three now live in one place, a Directory inside Claude where you browse and install them rather than hunting them down separately.

Cowork

Cowork is the agentic desktop mode that moved from research preview to general availability earlier in 2026.

You point it at a folder on your computer, give it a goal, and it reads, edits, creates, and organizes files on its own, checking in with you at key decision points instead of after every click.

It comes included on Pro and above, it's not a separate paid product. And it's aimed as much at marketers, ops people, freelancers, and researchers as it is at developers, which is a real shift from how most agentic tools have been pitched so far.

Scheduled tasks and Routines

You can now tell Claude to do something on a schedule instead of asking every single time. In Claude Code, this feature is called **Routines**. You write a task once, set a trigger (a daily schedule, a weekly cadence, or an event like a new pull request on GitHub), and it runs on Anthropic's own cloud infrastructure, *meaning it still works even if your laptop is off*.

Routines can be triggered by a schedule, an API call, or something like a GitHub event.

Daily limits depend on your plan, generally a handful of runs per day on Pro, up to around 25 on Team and Enterprise. Cowork has a similar idea for non-coding tasks, though it currently needs the desktop app open and running to keep working.

Claude Code and the developer side

Claude Code is the command line and IDE coding agent, available in terminal, VS Code, JetBrains, and even Slack. It's become the heaviest real world use case for Claude at this point, embedded in actual engineering workflows rather than something developers just try once.

Separately, the **Claude Developer Platform**, meaning the API and Console, is for people building their own products on top of Claude, billed per token instead of a flat subscription. Managed Agents is a newer beta layer for running Claude based agents at larger scale inside a business.

A few newer surfaces worth a quick mention: Claude in Chrome is a browsing agent, and Claude in Excel and Claude in PowerPoint bring Claude directly into spreadsheets and slide decks, all still in beta. There's also Claude for Small Business, a dedicated offering with ready made workflows for finance, sales, marketing, HR, and customer service.

Who's actually using it

- Individuals use Claude for writing, coding side projects, research, and the usual daily admin.
- Developers lean hardest on Claude Code.
- Enterprises in finance, healthcare, and other regulated industries use it specifically for handling long documents accurately and for compliance heavy work, companies like Novo Nordisk, Salesforce, Cox Automotive, Palo Alto Networks, and IG Group show up often as examples.
- Small businesses and solo entrepreneurs are a newer focus that Anthropic is building toward directly.
- Worth a brief, factual note here too: Claude has also been used in defense and cybersecurity work through a vetted program, and Anthropic has had real public friction with parts of the US government over military use limits, which connects back to the export control situation above.

The bigger picture

Anthropic's valuation has climbed fast, from around 60 billion dollars in early 2025 to about 965 billion after a Series H round in May 2026.

Reported annualized revenue crossed roughly 47 billion dollars around the same time, up sharply from under 10 billion the year before.

In June 2026, Anthropic confidentially filed paperwork for a possible IPO, and OpenAI did the same around the same window. None of that is confirmed or scheduled, it's a filing, not a listing, and whether either company actually goes public this year is still an open question.

On competition, ChatGPT still has the largest overall consumer audience, but its share has been slipping for the first time, while Google's Gemini has been growing fastest, helped by being built straight into Android, Search, and Workspace.

Claude remains the smallest of the three by total consumer traffic, **but it's winning a clear majority, often cited around 70 percent, of head to head enterprise deals against ChatGPT, especially in regulated industries.**

Three different strategies playing out side by side:

- ChatGPT chasing consumer scale,
- Gemini leaning on built in distribution,
- Claude betting on enterprise precision.

None of the three has settled the argument, and given how fast the export control situation and the IPO talk are moving, it's probably worth checking back in on this in another few months rather than treating any of it as fixed.

AI

Claude

Technology

ChatGPT

Artificial Intelligence



Published in No Time

11.2K followers · Last published 2 hours ago

Follow

Share through stories.



Written by Pranit naik

3.8K followers · 148 following

Follow

Started as a freelancer. Building a personal directory of AI and sharing what's worked for me.

